William Shakespeare's Jersey Shore
by Hank Frederick

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Walking home from a club are THE CIRCUMSTANCE, SNOOKERY, JUICEY, OPHELIA, and a girl referred to as THE CATAPULT. At rise, THE CIRCUMSTANCE and JUICEY hold up between them a passed-out VINCENZO, who is starting to stir.

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
The rogue doth awake! Good! He was beginning to slip
Off of my greased shoulder and chest.

JUICERY
Truthfully, I swore I would need to punch his face
For many turns of the clock's hands, to wake him.

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
And I knew cocksure he was dead, poisoned by a Chinaman's cologne
As our friend was, Donkey Jockey MacPaulie D.

JUICERY
Just the mention of sweet MacPaulie
Stirs in me a desire to punch an infant in the facebone.

VINCENZO
Hey, whoa. Like where are we, bro? What happened to the club?

SNOOKERY
Your fair and pinchable ass struck the floor of the hall,
Those seventeen tankards of mead had you going off the wall.

VINCENZO
Why are you talking like that?

OPHELIA
At standard pace with the Queen's words we converse,
Vincenzo. 'Tis you who speak queerly.

VINCENZO
Vincenzo! Is that me? Are you drunk?

JUICEY
Mayhaps I have poured near my face
Four score and seven mugs of warm tequila.

VINCENZO
Who are you people?

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
You and me, are two peas, in the most bulging pod.
I am The Circumstance, I doth flex my chest like God.

JUICERY
The masses quiver in fear and the ladies do pee pee
When they hear my title, mighty Juicery!

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
Our creed is spelled out in but three short words.
Fitness, Unctiousness, Cleanliness. F, U, C...

SNOOKERY
OK, cease your chattering, tiny hormone.
I am Lady Snookery, and I live only to find
the hairiest, most iron-biceped titans on this side of the earth.

OPHELIA
Oh Vincenzo, it is I, Ophelia,
Eternal love of the Juicery,
Who spurns my every advance,
Claiming I doth smother him
And thus interfere with his game.
What shall I do to win my bulging lord again?
I care not for any other from the boardwalk's beefery.
Vincenzo, go to him; for, by this light of the Jersey Shore
I know not how I lost him. Here I kneel (*she kneels*)
If e'er my will did trespass 'gainst his love,
Either in word or actual hook-up
Or that mine eyes, mine ears, or any other
Bit of my anatomy brought him to tears,
I shall fix it, or have a doctor fix it for me.

JUICEY
You wish to fight about it, Ophelia?

OPHELIA
Shut up you cave-dwelling steroid bat!
See, Vincenzo, our love is *so* star-crossed!

THE CATAPULT
I'M JUST A GIRL THEY PICKED UP AT THE CLUB! OH MY GOD I'M GOING TO SMUSHETH THE CIRCUMSTANCE! THAT'S SO COOL! I MUST DISPATCH TEXTUAL MESSAGES TO ALL 54 OF MY BESTEST FRIENDS!

SNOOKERY
That flimsy youth speaks in an almost unknown dialect,
belonging to a tribe of skanks who remain most drunk.

JUICEY
Brother Vincenzo, do not listen to the squelching Catapult.
The Circumstance himself dictated that we take her home
So that he might rub his overgreased chest upon her til dawn.

VINCENZO
A catapult? Is that her name?

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
The foulest of wenches, we dub Catapults,
For they are fit for nothing but to be launched towards the sea.
Tonight, Mercutio's Dance Palace held nothing but catapults.

CATAPULT
OH MY GOD AM I ON TV?? HI MOM!!!

CIRCUMSTANCE
So, I divined the most ready of them to soothe my manly itch,
And then to her fine booty did I my eyes affix.

OPHELIA
Juicey hath not even breathed my name tonight.
I shall find a keg of bitter mandrake, in which to drown myself.

JUICEY
You project such drama,
One would think we were in a play.

VINCENZO
Yeah, a Shakespeare play.

SNOOKERY
Shakespeare! Never heard of him.

VINCENZO
That's the first normal thing you've said all night.

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
To smush, or not to smush, that is the question
Whether tis nobler to suffer the rolls and blemishes of outrageous fugs,
Or by abstaining, use their sweaty arms against them.
To leave the club, to dance no more,
To end the thousand *untz untz untz untz's* of house music
Pounding against us,
To go home, have a sandwich, to sleep, perchance to dream,
And when we have gotten the gel out of our hair,
Aye, there's the rub (*keeps rubbing hair*) and the rub, and another rub,
What dreams may come, the undiscovered hottie,
Sun-branded, hair-woven, bosom-injected, gross-lipped...
But til then, the Fugs do make cowards of us all.

JUICEY
If the lady doth not please thee, Circumstance, I shall be a better circumstance for her. (*he grabs the girl*) Come, zitted temptress!

CATAPULT
OK AS LONG AS WE GET TO BE ON T.V.!! LET ME CALL MY BOYFRIEND REAL QUICK.

OPHELIA
You dare take up that cratered hussy
In my presence, dimwitted drool monkey?

JUICEY
Remove thy chains from me, saucy suction cup!

VINCENZO
Oh no. That girl is too drunk, Juicey. I'll walk her home.

JUICEY
Outta the way!

VINCENZO
You shall not pass!

JUICEY
Cometh at me, brother.

VINCENZO
By the power given to me by this foot long Subway meatball sandwich (*brandishes sandwich*), by the strength of all those who tanned righteously on our shores, You... Shall... Not... Pass!!

JUICEY
Brother, come at me!
Brother, come thus towards me!

VINCENZO
Alright, ok, come on Juicey, I'm just playin'. I meant nothing.

JUICEY
You call nothing, nothing?

VINCENZO
Yes?

JUICEY
I shall smash your skull with my littlest digit!
I shall have your eye out with my toe!
Cometh at me, brother!

VINCENZO
You know what? I'm gonna knock you out just so you shut up. Do you know how stupid you sound?

JUICEY
Do not try to calm me with flattery!

(*They fight. Vincenzo gains the upper hand, but then Juicey knocks him out with a sneak attack.)*

JUICEY
How doth my butt taste, toad phlegm?

VINCENZO (*passing out*)
Ask... your... mom.... (*out cold*).

(*Much noise. Suddenly, Vincenzo is surrounded by his housemates. They are screaming at him.*)

SNOOKERY
Wake up! Oh my god, if Vincenzo is hurt I'm going to be, like, almost hurt for him.

THE CIRCUMSTANCE
You got knocked out pretty good at the club, yo. Took a stripper pole to the face.

VINCENZO
Alas, how many hours have slipped by me, dreaming to climb such a pole,
And doff my head betwixt whatever cheeks I find there.

OPHELIA
Uh... Was that like Italianese or something?

JUICEY
Why you talking like that bro? You know how stupid you sound?

VINCENZO
What doth thou mean? In what manner does my tongue offend you?
Be still! Be still! No... no! S'blood, the curse hath fallen upon me!

SNOOKERY
Well, whatever. At least he's still hot. Let me kiss you and make it all better. (*She moves to kiss him, disgustingly*)

VINCENZO
A blindfold! A blindfold! My kingdom for a blindfold!

(END)